

N.L. Jolted By Eddie's Stepdown

By LEE LINDER

Philadelphia, April 14 (AP)—Eddie Sawyer quit as manager of the Philadelphia Phillies today—on the eve of his club's second game of the 1960 National League baseball season.

Gene Mauch, now managing Minneapolis of the American Association, was named to replace him.

"I just didn't want to manage," said 49-year-old Sawyer at a hastily-called news conference in owner Bob Carpenter's office at Connie Mack Stadium.

Lost Loop Opener

The Phils, last season's cellar club, hadn't been expected to go very far in the 1960 race. They lost the season opener at Cincinnati, 9-4, and meet Milwaukee tonight in the Philadelphia park's opening game.

This was the second time Sawyer quit as Phils manager during a season. He resigned in the middle of the 1952 season as the club floundered. Two years before his 1950 "Whiz Kids" copped the league pennant—the only one for the Phils in modern baseball.

No Camp Precedents

Sawyer was asked when he decided to quit and replied that "this notion has been with me the past few weeks." He said that training camp incidents involving discipline of players and criticism by some players of his managerial tactics had nothing to do with his decision.

Sawyer has benched most of last year's regulars in favor of untried rookies.

Carpenter, in prefacing the disclosure of the resignation, told newsmen that "I know that this is going to be a shock to you as much as it was to me."

Fined Three Players

Sawyer slapped \$100 fines on pitcher Jim Owens, infielder Joe Koppe and outfielder Bobby Gene Smith after they were involved in a fight with a bar patron at the club's Clearwater (Fla.) training base. Sawyer also has been openly critical of some of the Phils' ball-players and it was known there was some resentment against his public statements.

Carpenter said that Sawyer telephoned him last night to say he was quitting.

Mauch, 34, signed a two-year contract. He played as an infielder in the National League with Brooklyn, Pittsburgh, Chicago and the Milwaukee Braves. He also was connected with the Boston Red Sox of the American League.

Cohen Running Team

His managerial experience began in 1953 as a player-manager with Atlanta of the Southern Association.

Mauch was not on hand at the news conference and was not expected to report to the club before early tomorrow. Coach Andy Cohen was to run the team tonight.

Sawyer said that he hoped to stay in baseball but that he doesn't want to manage any more, anywhere.

His resignation severed all connections with the Phillies. But Carpenter said the door was still open for him to take another position with the club.

Mauch Aggressive

General Manager John Quinn said Mauch played for him with the Braves and "I recommend him to Atlanta as a manager. He is a very aggressive fellow and I'm certain he'll do a great job."